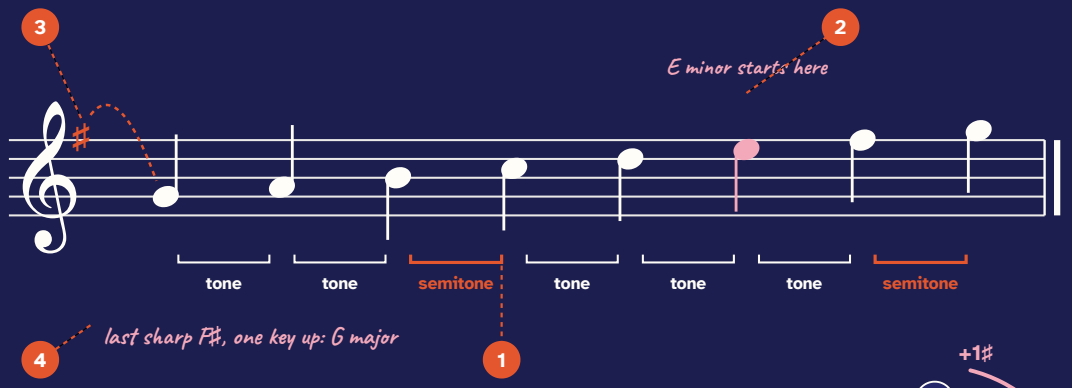
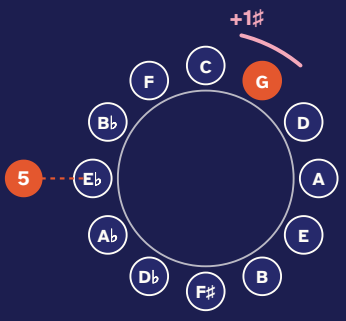
PART III · THE GROUND UNDER THE CHORDS

Scales and keys

Notes travel in families. Build the scales that whole pieces are made from, then learn to read the key a piece lives in: its signature, its home note, its place on the circle. All of it is in one scale.





1 **Major scales** p. 70
T T S T T T S: the two short steps

2 **Minor scales** p. 73
the same notes from the 6th note up

3 **Keys and key signatures** p. 76
the sharps at the start apply all the way

4 **Finding the key** p. 79
last sharp, one key up; second-last flat

5 **The circle of fifths** p. 82
clockwise, one more sharp each step

★ **Tips: when a note sounds wrong** p. 85